

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT



Project Title

Midlands State University National Language Institute (MSUNLI) Integrated Language Services and Operations Management System

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Midlands State University National Language Institute (MSUNLI) is a national centre of excellence responsible for language research, innovation, consultancy, translation, braille and sign language services across Zimbabwe's sixteen officially recognized languages. While the Institute has a strong mandate and national relevance, the Business Process Reengineering (BPR) GAP Analysis identified significant operational challenges affecting efficiency, service quality, staff workload and strategic impact.

Key challenges include manual client intake and quotation processes, role overload due to the secretary's triple role, fragmented data and information management, lack of performance measurement, weak technology infrastructure and limited automation of support functions. These issues create delays, reduce accountability and limit the Institute's ability to scale its services.

This Business Requirements Document defines the business-driven requirements for an integrated, automated system that will support MSUNLI's core service delivery, internal operations, performance measurement and stakeholder engagement. The document provides a clear foundation for system design, procurement and implementation.

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1. BUSINESS OBJECTIVES

The primary business objectives of the proposed system are to:

1. Improve efficiency and turnaround time for language services
2. Eliminate manual and fragmented processes
3. Reduce staff overload and operational bottlenecks
4. Enhance service quality and consistency
5. Enable performance measurement and accountability
6. Strengthen technology support for innovation and consultancy
7. Support MSUNLI's mandate as a national language hub

2. BUSINESS PROBLEM STATEMENT

2.1 Current State (AS-IS) Problems

Based on the GAP Analysis, MSUNLI currently faces the following business problems:

1. Secretary performs **triple roles** (secretary, receptionist, admin assistant)
2. Manual handling of:
 - Client intake
 - Quotations
 - Appointments
 - Payments follow-ups
3. No centralized system for:
 - Complaints
 - Leave applications
 - Procurement tracking
 - Workload management
4. Delays in assessment, approvals and communication
5. Lack of defined Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)
6. Inadequate technology infrastructure (printers, network, power backup)

7. Limited visibility into ongoing work and staff capacity

3. SCOPE OF THE SOLUTION

3.1 In Scope

The system shall support:

- Digital client intake and service request management
- Automated quotation and approval workflows
- Translation, editing, braille and consultancy workflow tracking
- Appointment and part-time staff management
- Internal administrative processes (leave, procurement requests)
- Performance monitoring and reporting
- Centralized operational data and documentation
- Role-based access for staff and management

3.2 Out of Scope

- Replacement of core MSU financial or HR systems
- External government system ownership (integration only)

4. STAKEHOLDERS

Stakeholder	Role
Executive Director	Strategic oversight
Deputy Director	Operational oversight
Secretary	Front office and coordination
Admin Assistant (TO-BE)	Administrative support
Receptionist (TO-BE)	Client intake
Language Experts	Service delivery
Part-Time Staff	Translation and consultancy
MSU ICT Directorate	Infrastructure and support
Clients	Service consumers

5. BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Functional Business Requirements

1. Client Intake Management

The system must provide a centralized digital portal for receiving, recording and tracking all client service requests.

2. Quotation and Approval Workflow

The system must automate quotation generation, review, approval and client notification.

3. Service Workflow Management

The system must track translation, editing, braille and consultancy services from request to completion.

4. Workload and Staffing Visibility

The system must provide visibility into staff assignments, workload distribution and part-time appointments.

5. Administrative Process Automation

The system must support digital submission and tracking of leave, procurement and internal requests.

6. Performance Measurement

The system must capture and report KPIs such as turnaround time, service volume and stakeholder satisfaction.

7. Reporting and Management Oversight

The system must generate management reports for decision-making and accountability.

5.2 Non-Functional Business Requirements

Category	Requirement
Accessibility	Web-based access
Reliability	Stable and dependable system
Usability	Easy to use for non-technical staff
Security	Role-based access
Scalability	Support increased service demand
Availability	Minimal downtime

6. BUSINESS RULES

- All service requests must be logged in the system
- Quotations must be approved before work begins
- Work must be assigned based on availability and expertise
- Performance data must be captured automatically
- Only authorized staff may approve quotations and reports

7. ASSUMPTIONS AND CONSTRAINTS

Assumptions

- Management will enforce system usage
- Staff will receive training
- ICT infrastructure upgrades will be funded

Constraints

- Budget limitations
- Change resistance
- Infrastructure challenges (power, connectivity)

8. SUCCESS CRITERIA

The system will be considered successful if:

- Manual processes are significantly reduced
- Service turnaround times improve
- Staff workload is balanced
- KPIs are consistently measured
- Management has real-time visibility of operations
- Client satisfaction improves

9. RISKS AND MITIGATION

Risk	Mitigation
Resistance to change	Training and change management
Poor data quality	Standardized data entry
Infrastructure failure	Power backup and network upgrades
Budget delays	Phased implementation

10. TRACEABILITY: GAP TO REQUIREMENT

Identified GAP	Business Requirement
Triple-role bottleneck	Digital intake and admin automation
Manual workflows	Workflow management system
No KPIs	Performance measurement module
Fragmented data	Centralized system
Poor tech support	Infrastructure enablement

11. APPROVAL AND NEXT STEPS

This BRD forms the basis for:

- System requirements specification (SRS)
- Architecture and design
- Technology procurement
- Phased system implementation

Approved By:.....

Signature:.....

Date:.....